

The point where the energy is released is called the focus of an earthquake. The point/place where the seismic waves are first recorded is called the epicentre.

16. Cocos Plate lies between-

- (a) Central america and Pacific Plate
- (b) South America and Pacific Plate
- (c) Red Sea and Persian Gulf
- (d) Asiatic Plate and Pacific Plate
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

The Cocos Plate lies between Central America and pacific Plate.

The Continents

*A continent is one of several very large land masses of the world. Ordered from the largest in area to the smallest, they are – **Asia** (44568500km²), **Africa** (30065000km²), **North America** (24473000km²), **South America** (17819000 km²), **Antarctica** (14200000km²), **Europe** (9948000km²) and **Australia** (7741220 km²). Area wise Australia is the smallest continent. According to Philip's Atlas the total land area of the various continents in proportion to the Earth is as follows – **Asia** 29.8%, **Africa** 20.3%, **North America** 16.2%, **South America** 11.8%, **Antarctica** 9.2%, **Europe** 6.8% and **Australia** 5.9%. *There are **48 countries** in Asia. To the south of Asia is the Indian Ocean, in the north is the Arctic Ocean, to the east is the Pacific Ocean. In the west, the Ural Mountain Range, Caspian Sea, Black Sea and Mediterranean Sea makes its borders with Europe. ***The Red Sea and Suez Canal** separate Asia from Africa. In the east, the **Bering Strait** separates it from **North America**. ***Europe** is a continent located entirely in the northern hemisphere and mostly in the eastern hemisphere. It is covered by water on three sides. It is bordered by the Arctic in the north, the Atlantic Ocean to the west and the Mediterranean Sea to the south. There are 49 countries in Europe. [Note - 5 countries such as Georgia, Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Russia and Turkiye are in both continents Asia and Europe]. ***Africa** is the second largest continent after Asia. The three important latitudes (Tropic of Cancer, Tropic of Capricorn and Equator) pass through Africa. There are 54 countries in the continent of Africa

more than any other continent in the world. ***The Strait of Gibraltar, Mediterranean Sea, Suez Canal, Red Sea and Arabian Ocean** separate Africa from Eurasia. To the east of Africa is the Indian Ocean and to the west is the Atlantic Ocean. ***North America** is a continent entirely within the Northern Hemisphere and all within the Western Hemisphere. The continent has been named after the Italian explorer Amerigo Vespucci. There are 23 countries in this continent. It is bordered to the north by the Arctic Ocean, to the east by the Atlantic Ocean and to the west by the Pacific Ocean. South America, Middle America, Mexico and the West Indies are collectively known as Latin America.

***South America** is bordered on the west by the Pacific Ocean and on the north and east by the Atlantic Ocean. The **Panama Canal** separates North America from South America. There are 12 countries in South America with Brazil being the largest one. *Antarctica is Earth's southernmost continent it contains the geographic South Pole and is situated, almost entirely south of the Antarctic Circle. **Antarctica**, on average, is the coldest, driest and windiest, and has the highest average elevation of all the continents. *The average elevation of the continents is as follows – Antarctica – 2300 m, North America - 760 m, Africa- 585 m, South America – 554 m, Asia – 923 m, Europe – 302 m, Australia – 330 m. Both Europe and South America have large proportions of their land as plain areas. Percentage wise Europe has more area under plains.

1. Which one of the following continents has the largest number of countries?

- (a) Africa
- (b) Europe
- (c) Asia
- (d) South America

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

The number of countries in the following continents is as follows :

Africa	54
Europe	49
Asia	48
North America	23
Oceania	14
South America	12

2. Among the following continents, which one has the highest number of countries?

- (a) Europe
- (b) Asia

- (c) Africa
(d) North America
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. As per area which of the following is the largest continent?

- (a) Europe (b) Africa
(c) North America (d) South America

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

There are a total of 7 continents in the world- Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Europe and Australia. Asia is the largest continent having an area of 44,568,500 sq. km. The area of other continents is as follows—

Africa	-	30,065,000 sq. km.
North America	-	24,473,000 sq. km.
South America	-	17,819,000 sq. km.
Antarctica	-	14,200,000 sq. km.
Europe	-	9,948,000 sq. km.
Australia	-	7,741,220 sq. km.

4. Which of the following countries is not located in the continent of Africa?

- (a) Gabon (b) Guyana
(c) Guinea (d) Guinea-Bissau

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Guyana is a country located in the continent of South America. Therefore Guyana is not located in the continent of Africa. The capital of Guyana is George Town. Gabon lies along the Atlantic coast of Central Africa. Guinea is in West Africa, bordered on the west by the Atlantic Ocean. Guinea - Bissau is a tropical country on West Africa's Atlantic coast.

5. From the code given below select the correct sequence of the following continents in terms of their area in descending order:

- (1) Europe
(2) Australia
(3) Africa
(4) South America

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 4, 1, 3, 2

(c) 2, 1, 4, 3

(d) 3, 4, 1, 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which of the following presents the correct sequence (in descending order) of the area of the continents?

- (a) Asia, Africa, North America, Europe
(b) Africa, Asia, Europe, North America
(c) North America, Africa, Asia, Europe
(d) North America, Asia, Africa, Europe

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

Asia	—	44,568,500 sq. km
Africa	—	30,065,000 sq. km
North America	—	24,473,000 sq. km
Europe	—	9,948,000 sq. km

7. Which one of the following is smallest Continent ?

- (a) Antarctica (b) Asia
(c) Europe (d) Australia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. The two smallest Continents of the world are –

- (a) Australia and Antarctica
(b) Antarctica and Europe
(c) Australia and Europe
(d) Australia and South America

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Which one the following is the correct sequence of the given continents in the descending order of their percentage of Earth's land?

- (a) North America–Africa–South America–Europe
(b) Africa–North America–South America–Europe
(c) North America–Africa–Europe–South America–
(d) Africa–North America–Europe–South America

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

According to Phillip's Atlas, the percentage of the land area of the continent in respect of their total land area of the Earth is as follows –

Asia	- 29.8%
Africa	- 20.3%
North America	- 16.2%
South America	- 11.8%
Antarctica	- 9.2%
Europe	- 6.8%
Australia	- 5.9%

Thus the descending order of continents given in the question in respect of their land area percentage is Africa – North America – South America – Europe.

10. Which of the following continents has the maximum per capita land ?

- (a) Asia (b) Europe
(c) North America (d) Australia

Uttarakhand Lower Sub. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

According to "World Bank data, the Australian continent has the maximum per capita land.

11. Which one of the following is the continent with the highest mean elevation in the world?

- (a) Antarctica (b) North America
(c) Asia (d) South America

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

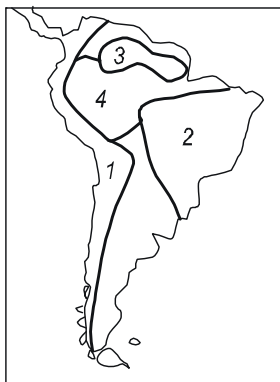
Ans. (a)

Antarctica is the continent with the highest mean elevation in the world. It is situated around the South Pole.

Average elevation of continents is as follows:

Antarctica	- 2300 meters
Africa	- 585 meters
North America	- 760 meters
South America	- 554 meters
Asia	- 923 meters
Europe	- 302 meters
Australia	- 330 meters

12. In the given figure the physical areas marked with 1,2,3 and 4 are respectively –



- (a) Andes, Brazilion shield, Guiana highland and Amazon basin.
(b) Andes, Guiana highland, Brazilian shield and Amazon basin.
(c) Amazon basin, Guiana highland, Brazilian shield and Andes.
(d) Guiana highland, Brazilian shield, Andes and Amazon basin.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

The marked areas in South America respectively are – 1. Andes 2. Brazilian Shield 3. Guiana Highland and 4. Amazon Basin. Thus option (a) is correct.

13. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

Geographical Features	Regions
(a) Abyssinian Plateau	: Arabia
(b) Atlas Mountains	: North-Western Africa
(c) Guiana Highlands	: South-Western Africa
(d) Okavango Basin	: Patagonia

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Mountain Atlas is situated in the north-west of the African continent.

Below is the correct location of other geographical areas –

Abyssinian Plateau - East Africa

Guiana Highlands - Northern South America

Okavango Basin - South - Western Africa

14. Which one of the following Continents has the highest percentage of plains in its total area ?

- (a) Asia (b) Europe
(c) North America (d) South America

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

Plains largely constitute Europe and South America however in terms of percentage Europe has the largest percentage of plains compared to its total area.

15. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer from the code given below -

List - I (Landform)	List-II (Continent)
(A) Aconcagua	(i) Australia
(B) Meseta	(ii) Africa
(C) Serengeti Plains	(iii) Europe
(D) Gibson desert	(iv) South America

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	iii	ii	iv	i
(b)	ii	iv	i	iii